

Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events

Name, Date and Venue	Topics	Contact address for details
E3 2017 June 13-15, 2017 Los Angeles, California, USA	Annual video game conference and show	Entertainment Software Association Website: www.e3expo.com
TechXL8 June 13-15, 2017 ExCeL, London, UK	Festival of technology for a journey between networks, tech and consumer services	TechXL8 Website: https://tmt.knect365.com
Internet of Things World Europe June 13-15, 2017 ExCeL, London	Platform to discuss adoption of Internet of Things (IoT) across consumer verticals	KNect365 Website: https://tmt.knect365.com/iot-world-europe/
Cyber Security Summit 2017 June 15, 2017 Hyatt Regency, Mumbai	It will bring together 120+ IT security leaders and policy makers from across industries	Ronald@exito-e.com
SES 2017 July 6-7, 2017 Bangalore International Exhibition Centre	8th edition of strategic electronics summit with focus on military, aerospace, homeland security and naval systems	ELCINA chandan@elcina.com
KE Show 2017 July 11-14, 2017 Huqiao International Expo Centre, Kunshan, Jiangsu Province, China	Event on intelligent automation and robotics	Taiwan Electrical and Electronic Manufacturers' Association (TEEMA) Website: www.TEEMA.org.tw
IFA 2017 September 1-6, 2017 Berlin, Germany	Meeting place for key retailers, buyers, and experts from the consumer electronics industry and the media	The German Association for Entertainment and Communications Electronics and Messe Berlin Website: http://ib2b.ifa-berlin.com
World Robot Olympiad India National Championship 2017 September 9-10, 2017	Robotics competition in India for students between the age group of 9 to 25 years	India STEM Foundation, and National Council of Science and Museum. Website: https://indiaSTEMfoundation.org/world/
AI World 2017 September 18-20, 2017 Boston, USA	Artificial intelligence (AI) world conference and expo	AI World 2017 Website: https://aiworld.com
TechXL8 Asia October 2-4, 2017 Marina Bay Sands, Singapore	Festival of technology that brings together Asia's telco and tech ecosystem to discover technologies that are enabling and shaping our connected future	TechXL8 Asia Website: https://tmt.knect365.com/techxl8-asia/
Tairotech Taipei October 11-14, 2017 Taipei, Taiwan	International trade fair for electronics and electronic components	Taiwan External Trade Development Council Website: http://www.taitra.org.tw/
Open Source India October 13-14, 2017 NIMHANS Convention Center, Bengaluru, India	Asia's annual convention to celebrate open source computing	Open Source India Website: http://opensourceindia.in/osdays/
ASSOCHAM Green Energy Summit November 9-12, 2017 Bangalore International Exhibition Centre	World expo and conference on renewable energy	ASSOCHAM India
Big Data London November 15-16, 2017 Olympia, London, UK	The UK's largest data and analytics event	Big Data London Website: http://bigdatadaily.com/
CeBIT INDIA 2017 November 30-December 2, 2017 White Orchid Convention Centre, Hebbal, Bengaluru	Digital innovation show	Hannover Milano Fairs India Pvt Ltd Website: www.cebit-india.com
ELEXCON 2017 December 21-23, 2017 Shenzhen Convention & Exhibition Center, China	Annual expo for the electronics industry based in Shenzhen	ELEXCON 2017 Website: www.elexcon.com/elexcon/en
CES 2018 January 9-12, 2018 Las Vegas, Nevada, USA	World's gathering place for those who thrive on the business of consumer technologies and where next-generation innovations are introduced to the marketplace	Consumer Technology Association Website: www.ces.tech
NEPCON Japan January 17-19, 2018 Tokyo Big Sight, Japan	Asia's leading exhibition for electronics design, R&D and manufacturing technology	Reed Exhibitions Japan Ltd Website: http://www.nepconjapan.jp/en/
Electronics West February 6-8, 2018 Anaheim Convention Center, California, USA	North America's largest annual design and manufacturing event	Electronics West Website: http://electronicswest.designnews.com/
Embedded World 2018 February 27-March 1, 2018 Exhibition Centre, Nuremberg, Germany	Trade fair for IT security for electronic systems	NürnbergMesse Website: www.embedded-world.de/en

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Smart home device sales to double in four years

In four years, annual growth of smart-phones sold will reduce from 30 per cent in 2014 to a mere four per cent, according to a new study by research and consulting firm Ovum. Meanwhile, the number of connected smart devices in use will nearly double from eight billion last year to 15 billion in 2021. This will lead smartphone majors like Apple and Samsung to seek new sources of growth in virtual reality, smart home and other reemerging segments.

Interactive audio speakers offer a more natural way than smartphones or tablets to control smart home devices. For example, Amazon's Alexa already has more than 10,000 'skills' that allow it to interact with a very large number of apps. However, smartphones will still be a critical component of driving smart homes, and by 2021 these will cement their position as the most popular consumer device of all time, with more than five billion in use.

Tech majors racing to invest in AI startups

According to a report by CB Insights, leading technology firms are investing in AI in order to capitalise on the shifting digital market. Prominent among them are Alphabet, Intel, Microsoft, IBM and Amazon.

In the last five years, Alphabet, the parent company of Google, has acquired as many as eleven companies closely associated with artificial intelligence. Google already uses RankBrain—an algorithm learning artificial intelligence system used in Google Search—for understanding queries and processing suitable responses.

In 2016, Intel acquired Itseez, Nervana Systems and Movidius, on par with Apple's acquisitions. It plans to develop semiconductors for AI apps.

Microsoft has been investing in AI technology for about 25 years now.